

Unit 7

HOBBIES

1. Vocabulary for speaking: Family

Kinds of hobbies (Các loại sở thích)

1. **cook:** nấu ăn
2. **dance:** nhảy
3. **do gardening:** làm vườn
4. **do yoga:** tập yoga
5. **go for a walk:** đi dạo
6. **go jogging:** chạy bộ
7. **do judo/ karate/ Vovinam:** tập judo/ karate/ Việt võ đạo
8. **go mountaineering:** đi leo núi
9. **go partying:** đi dự tiệc
10. **go shopping:** đi mua sắm
11. **go swimming:** đi bơi
12. **go to the gym:** đi tập thể hình
13. **hang out with friends:** đi chơi với bạn
14. **listen to music:** nghe nhạc
15. **play sports:** chơi thể thao
16. **play the guitar/ the piano/ the violin:** chơi ghi-ta/ piano/ vi-ô-lông
17. **read books:** đọc sách
18. **sing:** hát
19. **surf the Internet:** lướt net
20. **take photographs:** chụp ảnh
21. **travel:** du lịch
22. **walk my dog:** dắt chó đi dạo
23. **watch TV:** xem tivi

Adjectives to describe hobbies (Miêu tả sở thích)

24. **cheap** (adj.): rẻ
25. **creative** (adj.): sáng tạo
26. **different** (adj.): khác lạ
27. **enjoyable** (adj.): vui
28. **expensive** (adj.): tốn kém
29. **fascinating** (adj.): tuyệt vời

- 30. **meaningful** (adj.): *có ý nghĩa*
- 31. **perennial** (adj.): *lâu năm*
- 32. **practical** (adj.): *thực dụng*
- 33. **relaxing** (adj.): *thoải mái, thư giãn*
- 34. **unusual** (adj.): *không giống bình thường*
- 35. **vital = important** (adj.): *quan trọng*
- 36. **wonderful** (adj.): *tuyệt vời*

Other words and phrases to describe hobbies (Các từ và cụm từ khác miêu tả sở thích)

- 37. **a variety of**: *đa dạng*
- 38. **broaden one's horizons**: *mở mang đầu óc*
- 39. **bucket list**: *việc phải làm trước khi chết*
- 40. **cross it off my bucket list**: *gạch nó ra bucket list của tôi*
- 41. **creativity**: *sự sáng tạo*
- 42. **do/does wonders for my mental and physical health**: *có lợi cho sức khỏe tinh thần và thể chất của tôi*
- 43. **expand my knowledge/ know more about the world**: *mở rộng kiến thức của tôi / biết thêm về thế giới*
- 44. **experience** (v./n.): *trải nghiệm, kinh nghiệm*
- 45. **free of charge**: *miễn phí*
- 46. **gain popularity**: *trở nên phổ biến*
- 47. **generally speaking**: *nói chung*
- 48. **get muscular endurance**: *tăng cường sự dẻo dai*
- 49. **greatest inspiration**: *nguồn cảm hứng lớn nhất*
- 50. **hectic lifestyle**: *lối sống bận rộn*
- 51. **hobby = leisure pursuit = leisure activity = recreational activity = pastime**: *sở thích*
- 52. **I am no exception**: *tôi không phải là ngoại lệ*
- 53. **increase knowledge**: *tăng kiến thức*
- 54. **keep body in good condition**: *giữ cơ thể ở trạng thái tốt*
- 55. **keep you fit and healthy**: *giúp bạn giữ dáng và khỏe mạnh*
- 56. **make it more various**: *làm nó đa dạng hơn*
- 57. **mind control ability**: *khả năng kiểm soát tâm lý*
- 58. **music streaming website**: *trang web phát nhạc*
- 59. **musical instrumen**: *nhạc cụ*
- 60. **relieve stress after a stressful day/ week**: *giảm căng thẳng sau 1 ngày/tuần căng thẳng*
- 61. **strengthen my immune system**: *tăng cường hệ thống miễn dịch của tôi*
- 62. **take up**: *bắt đầu 1 sở thích, thói quen*
- 63. **take your mind off other troubles**: *loại bỏ những rắc rối trong tâm trí*
- 64. **temporarily escape reality**: *tạm thời thoát khỏi thực tế*
- 65. **the most important part of life**: *phần quan trọng nhất trong cuộc sống*
- 66. **the real joy of...**: *niềm vui thực sự của...*

2. IELTS Speaking Part 1: Introduction & Interview

Hobbies in general:

Giới thiệu về sở thích

- Because I'm a, I'm interested in + *Noun/V-ing*.
- I'm a, so I'm into + *Noun/V-ing*.
- I really enjoy + *Noun/V-ing*, because
- I'm keen on + *Noun/V-ing* ⇒ *Bạn cũng có thể thêm vào các trạng từ như "really", "quite" để nhấn mạnh ý của mình.*
- In my free time/ leisure time/ spare time, I enjoy/ like + *Noun/V-ing*.
- One of my perennial leisure activities/ pastimes is + *Noun/V-ing*.
- One activity that I enjoy doing is my spare time/ free time is *Noun/V-ing*.

1. What are your hobbies?

→ Because I'm a creative person, I'm interested in arts and crafts. These give me something interesting to do with my time.

→ I'm an outgoing person so I 'm into socialising/hanging out with friends. It's sociable because I've met lots of new people.

→ I really enjoy going to the gym because it keeps me fit. it gets me out of the house to be active.

2. How have your hobbies changed in the last 5 years?

→ I've always loved reading books from ever since being able to hold a book and now I'm reading a lot of English books to support my learning at university. I've turn my hobby into advantage.

→ I used to play a ton of video games when I was younger. I would spend the entire night playing online games until the sun came up. It was a very bad and expensive hobby. Though I still play some now, I don't play as much as I used to.

3. What hobbies would you like to try in the future?

→ To be honest, I would say that I would really like to try surfing in the future. I guess the reason why is that it is an exciting, adventurous sport. In addition to this, I would really love to go skydiving and master maneuvering (*sự vận động*) my body on air.

→ Well, If I have more spare time in the future, I will take up playing the guitar. Actually, I have found this musical instrument interesting ever since I was a kid so I really want to cross it off my bucket list.

Reading

4. Do you like reading?

Answer Yes, I definitely love reading.

What Besides textbooks, I normally read novels, newspapers and magazines.

Where & when While I'm on a coach, reading is what I usually do to kill time, and sometimes, I read books/magazines or listen to audio books on my iPhone/iPad/smartphone.

Why Reading, essentially, is a part of my daily since reading can ...

- broaden my horizon (*mở rộng tầm nhìn*)
- enrich my knowledge (*làm giàu kiến thức*)
- keep me up with the latest news and information (*giúp cập nhật tin tức*)
- cultivate my way of thinking (*rèn luyện tư duy*)
- enlighten my mind / set a fire in my mind (*khai sáng trí tuệ*)
- add a bit of fun to my life (*thêm chút niềm vui cho cuộc sống*)

Film

5. What's your favorite type of film?

→ Speaking of films, I am a big fan of [*comedy* / *action* / *romance* / *science-fiction* / *horror* / *zombie* / *animation* / *documentary* /] films. I love this kind of film simply because

- it cheers myself up / amuse myself / relax myself / release my pressure. (*comedy*)
- I can escape from my daily life and experience something that can hardly happen in real life. (*horror* / *zombie* / *vampire*)
- I can have a blast and blow my mind. (*action*)
- it boosts my imagination and pleases my eyes with visual effects. (*science-fiction*)
- it maintains my childhood interest. (*animation*)
- I can broaden my horizon and enrich my knowledge. (*documentary*)

6. Do you prefer foreign films to Vietnamese films? Why?

→ I enjoy both of them as long as they convey meaningful messages. When I was much younger, I thought only foreign films, especially Hollywood films would satisfy me, but now I am enjoying Vietnamese movies, too. They are seriously amazing.

→ Since Vietnam doesn't have a huge film industry, I've always been really into American films. Not to knock other film industries, but American ones are incredibly entertaining and well-made; the evolution of film continues to amaze me. Moreover, I only watch films in English so it helps me to learn new slang and expressions.

→ Well, if I were to choose between the two, I would probably go with the foreign films, especially the Hollywood films because most of them are well-acted, with lots of charismatic celebrities and always are enormous box-office hit; whereas you know, the Vietnamese films are almost low-budget, so they are not as attractive as their American counterparts.

7. Is going to the cinema to see a movie popular in your country?

→ Yes, I think so. Although nowadays TV and Internet actually have replaced the habit of going to the cinemas to watch movies, Vietnamese people still enjoy outings to cinemas as it can be considered as social events, which cannot be substituted by watching films at home.

Music

8. What kind of music do you enjoy listening to? Why?

- For me, I am interested in the traditional instrumental music, like pianos and guitars. It is an impressive combination that can give you a both nostalgic and modern feelings.
- I'm not completely into any type of music specifically, I listen to the music that fit my mood. If I'm happy, I will listen to pop or hip hop. And if I'm sad, I will just listen on repeat to jazz.
- Well, it certainly depends on my mood. When I feel unhappy, I play some dance songs and dancing boosts my mood! When I come back home after a boring day, pop music cheers me up and gives me a sense of accomplishment.

Travel

9. Do you like travelling?

- Answer** Undoubtedly yes, travelling is my most favourite.
- When & who** When I'm free from study, I like travelling to different places with my friends or family members.
- Where** We make trips to big cities like Vung Tau, ancient towns like Hoi An in Quang Nam Province, or mountainous cities like Da Lat.
- Why** Through travelling, I can ...
- meet different people / try different food / experience another culture
 - have a sense of freshness and newness
 - escape from daily life routines
 - get myself well-prepared for the future overseas life
 - achieve my long-term dream of taking a round-the-country tour

10. Do you prefer to travel alone or with others?

- Answer** Well, normally, I prefer travelling with others.
- Reason** simply because I may share many things, such as accommodation, transport, and even laughter, with my mates during the trip.
- Assumption** If I travel alone, I guess I will be lonely and I may even be helpless when there is a trouble.
- Opposition** However, occasionally, travelling alone can be more flexible and free, and I won't need to get with other people.
- Conclusion** So, it depends on my mood, but mostly, I prefer travelling in a group.

3. IELTS Speaking Part 2: Individual long-turn talk

Topic: **Describe a hobby you enjoy.**

You should say:

- how long you have been doing it
- how often you do it
- what benefits you get from it

and explain why you enjoy it.

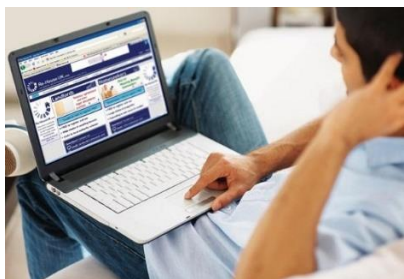
"Describe a hobby" seems like an easy topic. However, students often have difficulty speaking for 2 minutes when the topic is easy. Here are 3 pieces of advice to help you to speak for 2 minutes.

1. Think about question words: *What, when, where, why, who with*

- **What:** One of my hobbies is photography.
- **When and where:** I take photos on my phone almost every day, and I have a proper camera that I use on special occasions. If I see something interesting or I want to record a particular memory, I take photos wherever I am.
- **Why:** I take photos so that I have a record of the things I've seen or done.
- **Who with:** Most of my photos are of friends and family, but I also take pictures of interesting things that I see.

2. Tell a story related to the topic: The last time I took photos on a special occasion was at my friend's wedding a few weeks ago. I got some great pictures of the bride and groom and their guests celebrating. After the wedding I made an album of all the best pictures and sent it to my friend as a present.

3. Describe opinions and feelings: I like photography because it's a creative hobby and it makes you notice the world around you. I love capturing special moments or unusual or beautiful images, and it's a great feeling to be able to look back through my pictures and relive different experiences. These memories usually cheer me up.



Model answer 1: SURFING THE INTERNET

Introduction

- ☞ **What?** I must say that I have found a hobby which I could probably enjoy for the rest of my life without ever getting bored. My favourite hobby nowadays is surfing the internet.

Question words

- ☞ **Why?** I think that more and more people should consider surfing the internet as their hobbies because there are just so many interesting things to learn from the world wide web that it is almost impossible to get a better view of the world in which we live without surfing the internet.
- ☞ **How long?** I have been doing this for the last three years or so, and I just love it.
- ☞ **When & Where** The best thing about this hobby is that I can enjoy it anytime from the comfort of my home.
- ☞ **Who with?** Now, why would I think of going outside to enjoy some hobbies while I can do it right at my home with my family members and the loved ones?

Tell a story

- ☞ **Story/Examples** You want to learn about a unique aspect of a particular culture or tradition? Well, the internet has it whether you want just some written/text information or an actual video of it. You are interested to learn about the recipes of some delicious foods? The internet will provide you with tons of videos on it for you.

Opinions/Feelings

- ☞ **Importance** Anyway, this hobby is important for me because it stimulates my mind and brain unlike anything else. Besides, the wealth of information, I receive from the internet, helps me make a lot of informed decision which otherwise wouldn't be possible that easily.

Model answer 2: RUNNING

Introduction

- ☞ **What?** My hobby is running! I know I do not really look like a runner, and it is true I am not very fast, but this is still the activity that I like to do in my spare time.

Question words

- ☞ **How long?** I have not been running for very long.
- ☞ **When?** I started running just 18 months ago, as I decided I needed to get fit, and I thought it would be a cheap way to exercise.

- ☞ **Where & Who** I did not expect to enjoy myself. Each Saturday a group of people meet at a part near to where I live. We usually meet at 5.00 a.m. in the morning and go for a 5 km run together.
- ☞ **How often?** Now I go every week, and I even have trained for some longer races 10 km and my longest was 20 k.m.!

Tell a story

- ☞ **Story/Examples** I have made lots of friends through running. However, the best surprise was that when I went to a local park, I met an old friend I had not seen for over 10 years! We had been at school together but did not keep in touch. We had both moved to the new city of Ho Chi Minh City and did not realise we lived so close to each other. Now I run with this friend every week, and we go for breakfast each Saturday after our run.

Opinions/Feelings

- ☞ **Importance** Running is important to me because it keeps me fit, has helped me make new friends, and it has shown me that I am not too old to try new things! I hope you all find activities that you enjoy doing in your spare time!

Model answer 3: LISTENING TO MUSIC

Introduction

- ☞ **What?** I have never really been in any short of hobbies as I always like to try new and interesting things. But, one particular hobby, which has stuck with me more or less always, is to listen to music.

Question words

- ☞ **When?** I initially started to enjoy listening to music, as a young boy, about 10 years ago.
- ☞ **How?** But, if you ask me, how I became interested in this particular hobby, I would say that it probably came naturally to me. In fact, if someone sees that all of the family members, both young and old, like to listen to music, it probably would be very natural for that person to become “infected” with the same “habit” except, of course, it was not a habit, but rather, it was a nice “hobby” to keep us occupied and happy.

Tell a story

- ☞ **Story/Examples** As I grew older, I started to understand what kinds of musical instruments were needed to create or compose a song, and how many different kinds of music were really there. By the way, these days, I am a bit more selective about choosing my songs since I want to make sure that I am listening to the best songs and music, both in terms of their artistic values as well as the message they spread.

Opinions/Feelings

- ☞ **Importance** Anyway, I get a number of benefits from this hobby. The first benefit, of course, is that it makes me feel happy and glad while getting rid of my frustration and worries of life. It also helps me understand my life and its goal in a bigger frame of the present, past and future. Finally, it also stimulates my mind and body to accomplish more in life.

Model answer 4: READING

Introduction

- ☞ **What?** Reading is probably my favourite hobby or thing to do in my leisure time. It consists of picking up random fiction and non-fiction books and just spending some considerable time reading them.

Question words

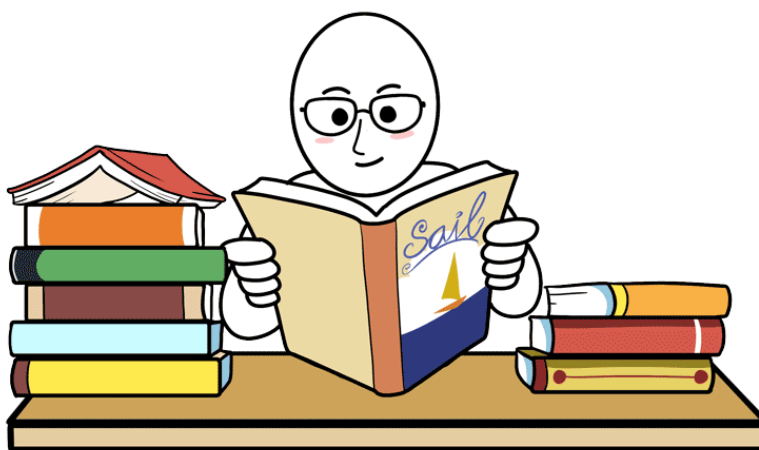
- ☞ **Who with?** I read alone in the quiet of my room or a serene spot in a garden. I like to spend a lot of time with fictional characters. I prefer being alone when I read to avoid distractions and interruptions.
- ☞ **When?** Once a week, I go to a nearby bookshop to purchase the novels of my favourite writers. I then spend considerable time reading as it is a very relaxing thing to do for me.

Tell a story

- ☞ **Story/Examples** Reading books is a hobby that should be inculcated in everyone, young or old, male or female, black or white. It is a good practice because it not only educates and enhances your knowledge about a wide range of topics and subjects but also makes you more aware of the world around you.

Opinions/Feelings

- ☞ **Importance** For me, reading is an escape into a parallel world where there are a set of people living their lives, and I get to be a voyeur looking in on the events and happenings. I would recommend reading to anyone and everyone!



4. IELTS Speaking Part 3: Discussion

HOBBIES

1. Do you think men and women tend to have different types of hobbies?

Câu hỏi về sự khác biệt: **What are the differences between X and Y?**

Để trả lời dạng câu hỏi trên, bạn cần:

- tìm những điểm khác nhau giữa X và Y.
- giới thiệu sự khác biệt:
 - *There are a number of underlying differences here.*
 - *There are a variety of possible differences here.*
 - *There are a range of potential distinctions here.*
- diễn tả sự khác biệt đầu tiên:
 - *However, I guess that the most significant would be that...*
 - *Though I suppose that the most obvious would be that...*
 - *But I would say the most fundamental would be that...*
- dùng các từ/ cụm từ diễn tả sự so sánh, từ trái nghĩa:
 - *Unlike X, Y tends to [+ từ/ cụm từ diễn tả sự so sánh]*
 - *X is, while Y is more likely to [+ từ trái nghĩa]*
 - *Compared with X, Y is less likely to*

→ Well obviously there are a number of clear differences. However, I guess that the most significant would be that men tend to prefer sporting activities such as football or basketball. Unlike men, women prefer things like shopping for clothes. In addition to this, another possible distinction might be that men usually like watching films, while women are more likely to prefer watching dating gameshows on TV.

2. How have hobbies changed since your parents were young?

Câu hỏi về sự thay đổi: **How have/has changed?**

Đây là một trong những câu hỏi thường gặp nhất. Khi trả lời câu hỏi này, bạn cần:

- nêu ví dụ cho thấy sự vật, sự việc, cách thức thực hiện hành động... nào đó ở thời điểm hiện tại có khác biệt so với trong quá khứ;
- có thể nhận xét rằng sự thay đổi hiện tại là rất lớn và đề cập nguyên nhân của sự thay đổi đó (như do Internet hoặc sự phát triển của khoa học kỹ thuật);
- chỉ ra rằng con người ngày nay không còn nhận thức và có quan điểm một chiều về các giá trị mà biết suy xét vấn đề từ nhiều khía cạnh.

→ There are many hobbies affected by trends. Back in the past, board games were very popular in Vietnam, such as 'parcheesi' (cờ cá ngựa). Many children and parents spent their holidays playing board games together. Nowadays, in this technological era, kids, young people, and adults choice changed a lot and they choose video games over board games. In addition, people who liked to

spend time exercising at the gym moved to yoga classes. There are many types of yoga are in the trend these days. Different yoga style suit all age group. So, some trends influence people's interests.



3. Do you think older and younger generations prefer different types of music?

→ Yes, I believe so. Logically people from different generation will have taste variation. Depending upon the maturity, music stars of their own age, impact of globalization as well as technological development in music industry will divide younger and older generation. For example, elderly people are usually big fans of classical music. In contrast, youngsters' taste in music is completely different, they always want to listen to their favourite rock bands or famous rappers.



FREE TIME

4. Do you think it can be a disadvantage to have too much free time?

→ Definitely yes. I mean, if you have too much free time, you will tend to lead a sedentary (*ngồi nhiều một chỗ*) lifestyle, become less active and turn into a couch potato. Whereas, if you always have something to do, it will keep you active physically and mentally. For example, daily workouts can always increase your energy level, and at the same time it strengthens your muscles and bones and many more. From another perspective, being on the go all the time is not ideal. That's why we need to keep a balance between our work life and our free time.

5. Do people have more free time now than in the past?

→ It's a strange irony that although we now have so many labour-saving devices such as washing machines and dishwashers, we feel we have less free time. Many of my acquaintances are always complaining that they are too busy. But actually I think our ancestors had less free time than us. The average worker hardly ever got any time off and worked six or seven days a week.